

# Start Here: Set Your Weights and Syllabus

MJ U.S. History: 1492–Reconstruction · Florida course 2100010 · Grade 7

**Read this before the term starts.** Two things in this course are deliberately left for you to set: the assignment group weights in Canvas, and the grading section of the syllabus you hand to families. They do not currently agree with each other, and they cannot be reconciled centrally — this course is taught in both Live and On-Demand sections by several different teachers, each setting their own weights and pacing. Reconciling them for your section is your job, and it takes about ten minutes.

## STEP ONE

### 1 Set your grade weights in Canvas

The course ships with four weighted assignment groups. Confirm these or change them before you publish anything. In Canvas go to **Assignments**, open the : menu at the top right, and choose **Assignment Group Weight**.

| Assignment group             | Group ID | Ships at | What lives here                                                                       |
|------------------------------|----------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tier 1: Student & Material   | 205      | 55%      | 18 Reading Quizzes, 36 VR Activities. Auto-graded or completion-scored.               |
| Tier 2: Student & Community  | 227      | 30%      | 18 Discussions, 18 Critical Questions, 11 Primary Source Exercises. All teacher-read. |
| Tier 3: Student & Teacher    | 228      | 15%      | 7 Primary Source Reports, 2 Quarter Capstones, 2 Quarterly Exams. Rubric-scored.      |
| Tier 4: Ungraded Scaffolding | 229      | 0%       | Module Intro and Outro Wrappers. Surveys, not graded.                                 |

## STEP TWO

### 2 Then edit your syllabus to match

The syllabus masters in this module were written before the Canvas gradebook was built, and they describe a different scheme: **60%** asynchronous homework, **30%** projects, **10%** synchronous homework and activities. That will not match whatever you set in Step 1.

1. Download the `.odt` or `.docx` for your section from this module.
2. Correct the **Assessment & Grading** section so it states the weights you actually set.
3. Add your contact details and office hours in the header block.
4. Adjust the calendar for the term you are teaching (see Step 4).
5. Reupload your edited copy and let your course lead know, so the syllabus families see in Canvas is refreshed.

**On-Demand teachers:** the syllabus lists a 10% category for live class participation and discussion. That category does not apply to your section. Discussions in this course are graded inside Tier 2, not as live participation.

### STEP THREE

## 3 Know how the Quarterly Exams are weighted

Both Quarterly Exams sit in **Tier 3**, which is capped at whatever percentage you assign that group. Raising an exam's point value only redistributes weight *within* Tier 3, alongside the seven Primary Source Reports (16 points each) and the two Capstones (20 and 24 points). It does not raise the exams' share of the course grade.

If you want the exams to count for more, change the **Tier 3 group weight**, not the exam point values. At the shipped 15%, the two exams together are a meaningful minority of a band that also carries nine other major assessments.

### STEP FOUR

## 4 Check the scope against your term

The syllabi lay out all four quarters, through the Civil War and Reconstruction, with milestone dates running to the end of the school year. **Only Quarters 1 and 2 are built** — Modules 1 through 18, covering 1492 through Washington's presidency. Quarters 3 and 4 are a future build phase.

Adjust the calendar and scope language in your syllabus so families are not promised content that is not yet in the course.

## Everything else

The **Teacher Manual (Facilitator Copy)**, also in this module, covers how the course runs day to day: the assessment catalog and how to grade each type, the rubrics and their Canvas IDs, the workload map, standards coverage, the documented exceptions, and the sensitive-content flags. Read it next.